

Needs of plants and animals

identify the basic needs of plants and animals, including air, water, food or shelter, and describe how the places they live meet those needs.

Learning intention

- identify the basic needs of plants and animals, including air, water, food or shelter, and describe how the places they live meet those needs.

Teach and model

- identifying what they do to look after pets or plants at home and grouping these activities.
- exploring why caring for plants and animals is important including as sources of food and fibre.
- creating dioramas of a place a plant or animal lives, and identifying the features that enable it to meet its needs.

Check understanding

- Explain the main idea and give one accurate example.
- Show the idea in a second way: with words, a model, a diagram or symbols.
- Apply the idea to a short unfamiliar situation and justify the result.

Teaching cautions

- Ask the student to explain their choice, not only state an answer.
- Check that key vocabulary is understood in a new example.
- Mix representations so the skill is transferred rather than copied.

Quick lesson sequence

- Connect to prior knowledge and introduce the key vocabulary.
- Model one clear example, then solve a second example together.
- Finish with an independent check and a short student explanation.